

End-of-Lease Bond-Back Checklist — Western Australia

Protect your money — recent reforms changed how bond disputes are handled.

Correct as at July 2026. General information only, not legal advice.

Section 1 — Understand How Your Bond Works (Recently Changed)

- ☐ [] **Know about the 2026 bond release reforms.** Following the Residential Tenancies Amendment Act 2024, significant changes to the bond release process commenced on **28 March 2026** — the process is designed to be more streamlined and transparent than the previous system.
- ☐ [] **Know any party can now initiate bond release.** Previously only the owner or property manager could start this process — as of the 2026 reforms, the tenant can also initiate a bond release request.
- ☐ [] **Understand bond disputes are no longer automatically sent to the Magistrates Court.** Disputes are now handled through a Commissioner-based process first.
- ☐ [] **Know that fair wear and tear cannot be claimed against your bond.**

Section 2 — Before You Move Out

- ☐ [] **Locate your original entry condition report** — your baseline for comparison.
- ☐ [] **Compare the property's current condition against that report**, room by room.
- ☐ [] **Clean thoroughly**, addressing anything genuinely beyond fair wear and tear.
- ☐ [] **Check every item on the original inventory** is present and in working order.
- ☐ [] **Settle any outstanding rent** before vacating.

Section 3 — At the Final Inspection

- ☐ [] **Attend the final inspection if you can**, comparing the property against the original condition report.
- ☐ [] **Take your own timestamped photos** of every room after cleaning, regardless of whether the agent attends.
- ☐ [] **Keep every receipt** — cleaning, repairs, pest control — as evidence.

Section 4 — Claiming Your Bond

- ☐ [] **Initiate the bond release process yourself if needed** — this is now an option available to tenants directly under the 2026 reforms, not just the landlord/agent.
- ☐ [] **If both parties agree**, the bond is released according to the agreed split.
- ☐ [] **If there's a disagreement**, the matter goes through the Commissioner-based determination process first.
- ☐ [] **Know your appeal rights.** If you disagree with a bond determination, you can appeal to the **Magistrates Court within 7 days** of the decision.

Section 5 — If There's a Dispute

- ☐ [] **Gather your evidence before lodging a dispute:** entry and exit condition reports, timestamped photos, receipts, and correspondence.
- ☐ [] **Be aware the new process has had mixed early feedback.** Since the reforms only commenced in March 2026, some cases have experienced delays in determinations, and once a matter is referred to the Commissioner, there's generally no further opportunity for negotiation between parties — so try to resolve informally first if there's any real prospect of agreement.
- ☐ [] **If you disagree with the outcome, act quickly** — the 7-day appeal window to the Magistrates Court is tight.

Quick Reference — WA Bond Process (Post-March 2026 Reforms)

ITEM	DETAIL
Bond release reform	Commenced 28 March 2026 (Residential Tenancies Amendment Act 2024)
Who can initiate release	Any party — tenant, owner, or managing agent
Dispute resolution	Commissioner-based process, not automatic Magistrates Court referral
Appeal window	7 days to the Magistrates Court
Maximum pet bond	\$350
Fair wear and tear	Cannot be claimed against bond

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